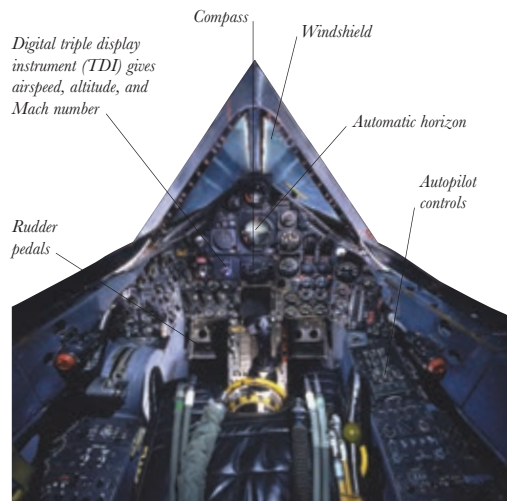




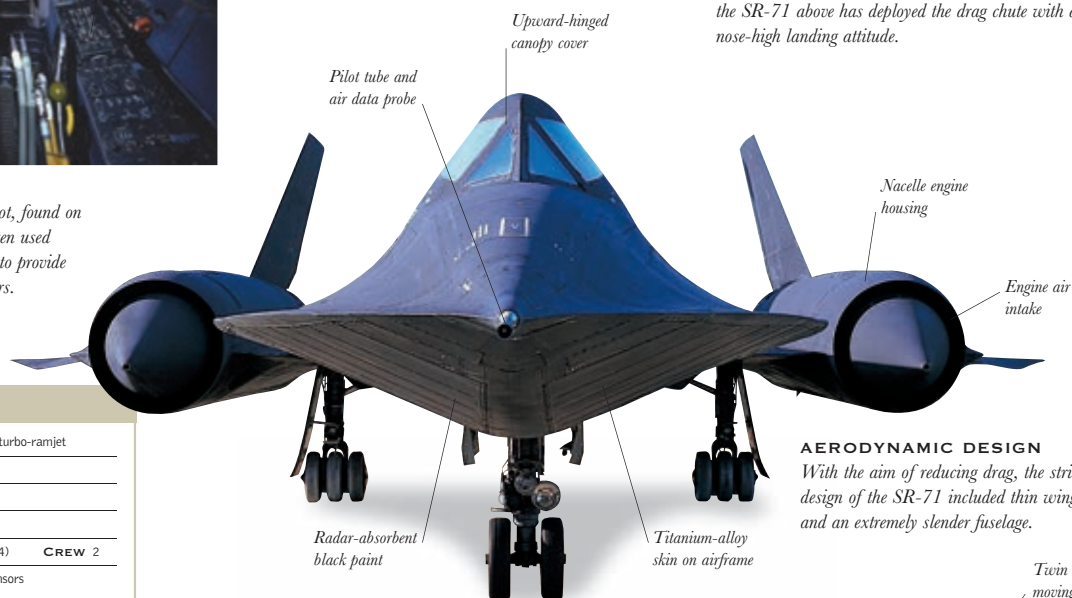
AUTOMATIC FLYING

The SR-71 featured an excellent autopilot, found on the right-side panel. This feature was often used during reconnaissance missions, in order to provide maximum stability for the imaging sensors.



SLOWING DOWN IN A HURRY

In order to reduce its speed quickly when landing, the SR-71 made use of a drag chute. The pilot flying the SR-71 above has deployed the drag chute with a nose-high landing attitude.



Specifications (SR-71A)

ENGINE 2 x 32,500lb (14,742kg) P&W J58 turbo-ramjet

WINGSPAN 55ft 7in (16.9m)

LENGTH 107ft 5in (32.7m)

WEIGHT 67,500lb (30,618kg)

TOP SPEED 2,250mph (3,620kph) (Mach 3.4)

CREW 2

PAYLOAD 20,000lb (9,072kg) specialized sensors

AERODYNAMIC DESIGN

With the aim of reducing drag, the striking design of the SR-71 included thin wings and an extremely slender fuselage.

HIGHEST AND FASTEST

The Blackbird, which first flew in 1964, remains the highest- and fastest-flying turbojet aircraft in history. Its nickname came from the special color scheme that helped to dissipate heat and absorb enemy radar emissions.

